

CREATING YOUR FITNESS IDENTITY

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- One of the biggest limiting beliefs people have about starting their online coaching business is imposter syndrome
- Imposter syndrome is the internalized belief someone has when they doubt their skills, abilities, and talents and are afraid of being exposed as a fraud

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- Imposter syndrome is common and tends to present itself when you are undergoing a transformation externally
- What happens is your environment and the people around you know you under a certain identity

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- Somewhere along the lines you met every individual person in your life, and when you met them you made an imprint on them
- In that experience that made an identity of who they think you are based on their experience
- If you met in school then you're a classmate, if you met at work then you're a co-worker, if you met at a party then you're outgoing, etc

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- As humans we have cognitive biases
- What this means is our brains practice shortcut patterns to save ourselves time
- So instead of getting to fully understand someone, we will create an identity of who we think they are based on our experience
- This has happened to you and the people you've met

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- Imposter syndrome comes when you adopt other people's identity of you as your own, and hide your true identity in fear of what others might think or say
- It's when you value how other people see you more than who you truly are
- This creates a dissonance of feeling like an imposter

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- How other people think they know you is not true to you
- You are doing yourself a disservice by valuing other people's perception of you over your own
- You have to release and let go of all these other identities as false

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- I call this killing your identity
- In order to move forward into new chapters in life, especially starting a new business, you have to kill your old identity
- You cannot become who you are meant to be in an environment that keeps you who you were

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- This can be an internal process done by journaling and saying goodbye to your old self
- What you can do here is list all the self-destructing behaviors, limiting beliefs, and constraints you face on a piece of paper
- Doing this will help you identify what you are not so you can make room for who you will become

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- It can also be an external process of letting go of old items that are taking up mental space in your mind
- Something you can do often as you evolve is get rid of old clothes and re-decorate your room
- Changing your external environment will help you let go of your past self

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- After you have let go of your old identity, you have to realize that in order to achieve a new goal, you have to become a new person
- The identity you have now is not the identity that is going to get you to the end goal
- Otherwise we would be there already

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- For each new phase and step in your journey,
you have to become someone new
- Someone better than you were before
- Someone that is aligned with who you want to be
- Someone that you can portray online that allows
others to see you for who you truly are

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- This new identity needs to be a character you play
- Someone that you can act as in order for others to see you as you need to be seen
- I call this creating your fitness identity
- What we need to do is create an identity of being a fitness coach

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- You might not yet be seen by others as a fitness coach, and this is where imposter syndrome comes into play
- So we have to create the identity of the fitness coach and act as if that is who we are
- What will happen then is others will start to see and perceive you as the fitness coach

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- Once this happens then you are in alignment between who you are and who you need to be
- When you begin to act out this character in real life, other people will start to believe that is who you are
- Their perception of you will change and your identity will change with it

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- You are a coach
- You need to act like a coach, post like a coach, speak like a coach, think like a coach
- When you embody the coaching identity, you will be the coach in other people's eyes

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- To help you create this identity, there is a worksheet down below that will walk you through how to create your fitness identity
- I recommend that you do this exercise if you struggle with imposter syndrome and then practice embodying the character that you create.

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- You will need to do this exercise every 6-12 months because as time passes, you grow and your goals change.
- For each new goal you will need to become a new version of yourself in order for you to reach those goals

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- Practice intentionally recreating yourself to break through new levels in life
- Once you have your identity created, you need to act “as if”
- It might not be natural for you to be this new version of yourself, so you will need to “fake it till you make it”

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- This means playing the role you need to play in order for you to get the result you desire
- Your identity is a new character and you will play them in order for you to take action
- This might feel fake at first, but as you continue to show up as your new identity, you will begin to get new results

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- Once you start to see results in yourself and your confidence you will begin to adopt this new identity
- As you show up others will begin to see you as this new identity as well
- And when other people begin seeing you as this person, you have successfully overcome imposter syndrome

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- At this point, you are who you need to be and other people see you as the person you need to be
- They see you as the coach
- This is what it means to be in alignment with yourself

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- Now this is not a 1 time fix
- Imposter syndrome is a thought pattern that will creep up over and over
- You will have to consistently remind yourself who you are and what you are here to do
- Everytime your old identity creeps in you will need to revisit this exercise

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- In the beginning make it a daily habit to work on your identity
- Do the Creating Your Identity Homework every morning to remind yourself who you need to be in order for you to crush the day

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- Lesson Complete